5 Things Every Expat Should Know Before Getting a Car in Hong Kong

A short welcome read from ExpatAutoAdviser

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ExpatAutoAdviser.com 5 Things Every Expat Should Know Before Getting a Car in Hong Kong Your quick starter guide from ExpatAutoAdviser A quick starter guide from the ExpatAutoAdviser team — the five things worth knowing before you start looking at cars. Keep an eye on your inbox for more detailed guides and market updates. 1 First Registration Tax is brutal FRT is charged on the car's taxable value at rates from 46% up to 132%. A Toyota Corolla Cross with a HK$280,000 list price has an FRT of HK$180,800 — making the real purchase cost HK$460,800. 2 Parking matters more than the car In Central and Mid-Levels, residential parking can cost HK$5,000-12,000/month — if it's available at all. Many older buildings have zero parking. Solve the parking question before you solve the car question. 3 Don't rush to buy For many expats in Central, the honest answer is "don't own a car". Taxis, MTR, and weekend hire cars may cost less than a car that sits in an expensive parking space 90% of the time. Do the real comparison first. 4 Convert your UK licence in month one The UK is on Hong Kong's Approved Country list — your full UK licence converts without a practical test. Bring your passport, HK ID, UK licence, photos, and the fee. Done in under two weeks. 5 Running costs add up fast Insurance, tunnel tolls, parking, fuel, and maintenance stack up quickly in Hong Kong. Before committing, calculate the full annual running cost — not just the purchase price. A three-year total cost comparison against taxis/MTR is the most useful number you can calculate. Want the full breakdown? Visit ExpatAutoAdviser.com for detailed guides on COE, FRT, insurance, and more. Published by NewMediaWorld Pte. Ltd., April 2026. ExpatAutoAdviser.com